

Shipflow.se

Complete Redesign & Production Launch

Overview

Timeline	March – May 2026
Role	Solo Developer & UI Designer
Status	Live in production
Client	Flowtech International AB

Context

Flowtech International AB operates a global platform used by leading shipyards, design offices, and universities across Asia, North & South America, and Europe. They needed to modernize their public-facing website for better user experience and clearer information architecture.

User Research (2 weeks)

I conducted interviews with two key users: the directing manager and an engineer who actively uses the software. The goal was to identify what information was missing, what should be included, and what should be removed from the new design.

Outcomes:

- Clear understanding of user workflows and priorities
- Identified missing features and confusing information architecture
- Determined key content areas to emphasize

Design Process (3 weeks total)

Week 1-2: Initial Design

Started with visual direction: colors, typography, layout. Created initial designs to show stakeholders the visual direction.

Week 3: Refinement & Iteration

Gathered feedback from the directing manager and engineer. Refined designs based on their input. Finalized all page views with consensus on layout, content hierarchy, and visual design.

By the end of design phase, all decisions were made: page structure, components, colors, typography, and content organization.

Implementation (6+ weeks)

Stage 1: Technology Decision

Evaluated options for the best platform. Decided on WordPress. Investigated hosting providers and recommended HostUp.

Stage 2: WordPress Build

With design finalized, focused on development. The only outstanding task was gathering real content from Flowtech. Built custom post types, integrated plugins, configured hosting, and deployed to production.

Technology Stack

Category	Implementation
CMS	WordPress (Twenty Twenty-Five FSE theme)
Plugins	Contact Form 7, Profile Builder, Fluent Support, ACF, WP Mail SMTP (Brevo), Newsletter, Yoast
Custom Features	User dashboard with license display, Documents library, Video tutorials, Publications directory
Infrastructure	HostUp hosting, Brevo email, MySQL database
DNS & Security	Domain configuration, SSL certificate, daily backups

Features Delivered

- **Custom Post Types:** News/Posts with category badges, Documents with filtering, Video tutorials with metadata, Publications directory
- **User Management:** Role-based access control, user profile pages showing account info and license details
- **Support Portal:** Integrated Fluent Support for customer support tickets
- **Email Integration:** Newsletter signup via Brevo, transactional email for contact forms and support tickets
- **Content Management:** File storage system for documents and videos, SEO optimization via Yoast
- **Infrastructure:** Automated daily backups, SSL certificate, DDoS protection

Testing & Launch

The internship timeline was limited, which constrained formal testing phases. However, the site was thoroughly reviewed by both myself and the directing manager before launch. All core functionality was verified: form submissions, user login, document downloads, video playback, and email delivery.

The site went live and has been serving Flowtech's global customer base in production.

Handover & Documentation

Created comprehensive handover documentation covering: site overview, hosting setup, WordPress admin access, plugin usage, how to publish news, add documents, manage videos, configure email, manage support tickets, newsletter management, SEO optimization, backups, and DNS configuration. Identified known issues for future resolution.

Key Learnings

- **User interviews drive design.** Talking to actual users revealed priorities that initial assumptions missed.
- **Get stakeholder buy-in early.** Iterating design with feedback prevented misalignments later.
- **Platform choice matters.** WordPress with ACF gave flexibility for custom post types and content management.
- **Documentation is deliverable.** Clear handover documentation made the project complete and maintainable.
- **Constraints breed focus.** Limited internship time forced prioritization of what matters most.

What This Project Proved

End-to-end project ownership: from understanding user needs through design iterations to full implementation and deployment. Ability to make technology decisions (WordPress over alternatives). WordPress expertise including custom post types, plugin integration, and infrastructure setup. Written communication through comprehensive handover documentation.

Live Site: <https://shipflow.se/>